

Reichstag Fire

27th Feb 1933 ⇒ Reichstag Building was burnt down

At first ⇒ many Germans felt that this was the work of the Nazi party themselves

⇒ later turned out to be the work of a lone and mentally unstable communist Marinus Van der Lubbe.

Hitler ⇒ immediately ⇒ declared that the fire was the beginning of a communist uprising.

→ persuaded Hindenburg to pass the decree for the protection of the people and the state ⇒ gave Hitler sweeping emergency powers

- Police, SA, SS ⇒ arrested 4000 communists on the night of the fire alone.
- Opposition party meetings, newspapers and radio broadcasts ⇒ were also banned.
- Made it hard for opposition parties to campaign

Elections of 5th March ⇒ Nazis gained 288 seats.

⇒ with support of 52 delegates from German national people's party ⇒ they had 52% of seats.
